



SLINGSHOTS

Slingshots, also known as catapults, work in a different way from the catapults aboard aircraft carriers. Pulling back on the rubber band of a slingshot stores energy in it. That energy then propels a stone or other object forward when the rubber band is released.

How steam catapults work

Just before takeoff, hot steam held in a large accumulator tank is released through pipes into the main cylinder that runs along the length of the runway, just below the deck. The steam's pressure pushes a piston that drags along a shuttle with enormous force—pulling the plane forward at great speed.

